Julian Lee-Sursin

Curriculum Vitae — November 2026

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Research Interests: Language, Cognition, Epistemology

Research Position

Visiting Scholar (*chercheur invité*), Johns Hopkins University 2025–2026
Department of Comparative Thought and Literature
Invited research position with independent fellowship (see Fellowships & Awards)
Report: julianleesursin.com/Rapport_de_sejour_final.pdf

Education

École Normale Supérieure, **MS** in Cognitive Science 2024–present
17/20 GPA (first year)[1]

Johns Hopkins University, Visiting Graduate Student 2025–2026
With full tuition grant to enroll in graduate courses (see Fellowships & Awards)

Sorbonne Université, **MPhil**, 2023–2025
Mention très bien (highest honors)
Spécialité : Philosophie des sciences, de la connaissance et de l'esprit

Oberlin College, **BA**, French and Philosophy, Honors in Philosophy 2020–2023

Papers

2. **Lee-Sursin, J.** (forthcoming, 2026) "Panpsychism and the Individuation Problem: Comments on Taofeek"
Southwest Philosophy Review, 42 (2)

1. **Lee-Sursin, J.** and Ryoo, H.J. (2026) "A Regress Argument Concerning Autonomous Self-Correction in AI Agents"
Preprint: https://philsci-archive.pitt.edu/id/eprint/30629

Under Review (Drafts available upon request)

- "Is Acquaintance a *Sui Generis* Epistemic Relation?"
A draft of this paper was awarded the *Indiana Philosophical Association 2025 Graduate Paper Prize*
- "Perception and Mode-Dependent Content in Fashion"
A draft of this paper was awarded an Honorarium by the Institut Français de la Mode
- "Towards a Cognitive Model of Informativeness"
- "From Complementarity to Explanation" (with Hong Joo Ryoo)

[1] Grades in France are assigned on a scale from 0–20. An average of 10 is passing, 12 awards honors (*mention assez bien*), 14 awards high honors (*mention bien*), and 16 awards highest honors (*mention très bien*).

Conference Presentations

* = abstract refereed ** = paper refereed † = invited

26. New work on why-questions, title TBD (*) — Jan 13-16, 2027
American Philosophical Association, Eastern Division Meeting, Boston, MA
Papers in Progress Workshop

25. "Is Acquaintance a *Sui Generis* Epistemic Relation?" (**) — Nov 13, 2026
Southwest Philosophical Society Annual Meeting, El Paso, TX

24. "A Truthmaker Semantics for Constraint-Based Explanation" (**) — Oct 16, 2026
Illinois Philosophical Association Annual Meeting, Normal, IL

23. "A Regress Argument Concerning Autonomous Self-Correction in AI Agents" (*) — Sep 4, 2026
(with Hong Joo Ryoo)
SOPhiA, Salzburg, Austria

22. "Presentism Precludes Explanation" (**) — Aug 28, 2026
European Congress of Analytic Philosophy, Madrid, Spain

21. "Curb Your (Brain-Model Alignment) Enthusiasm" (*) — Aug 26, 2026
(with Arnold Fleishman)
European Congress of Analytic Philosophy, Madrid, Spain

20. "A Semantic Argument Against Radical Cognitivism" (**) — July 10, 2026
Joint Session of the Aristotelian and Mind Societies, Reading, UK

19. "Towards An Explanatory Cognitive Model for Blackwell Informativeness" (*) — June 18, 2026
International Conference on Model-Based Reasoning, Rome, Italy

18. "Answering Why-Questions" (*) — June 13, 2026
Swedish Congress of Philosophy, Stockholm, Sweden

17. "On Fashion's Perceptual Content" (**) — June 9, 2026
European Society for Aesthetics, Jyväskylä, Finland

16. "Do AI Agents Meet the Epistemic Norms for Explanation?" (*) — Apr 25, 2026
Inaugural Humanities of AI Workshop, JHU, Baltimore, MD

15. "On Fashion's Perceptual Meaning" (**) — Apr 10, 2026
American Society for Aesthetics, Eastern Division Meeting, Philadelphia, PA

14. "On Why-Questions" (†) — April 9, 2026
Semantics Lab, Department of Cognitive Science, JHU, Baltimore, MD

13. "A Semantic Argument Against Radical Cognitivism" (**) — April 4, 2026
University of Florida Graduate Philosophy Conference, Gainesville, FL

12. "Why Presentism Precludes Explanation" (*) — Feb 18, 2026
American Philosophical Association, Central Division Meeting, Chicago, IL
Philosophy of Time Society, Affiliated Group Session

11. "How Causation Explains: A Semantic Inquiry" (*) — Jan 7, 2026
American Philosophical Association, Eastern Divison Meeting, Baltimore, MD
Society for Philosophy of Causation, Affiliated Group Session

10. "Fashion and the Jacksonian Mode: Intentionality Beyond Language" (**) Nov 20, 2025
    Symposium, Institut Français de la Mode, Paris, France

9. "Semantics for Explanation" (**) Nov 8, 2025
    Illinois Philosophical Association Annual Meeting, Charleston, IL

8. "Composition and Metalinguistic Negotiation" (†) Nov 3, 2025
    Talk for philosophy majors and faculty, Oberlin College, Oberlin, OH

7. "Is Acquaintance a *Sui Generis* Epistemic Relation?" (**) Nov 1, 2025
    Indiana Philosophical Association Annual Meeting, Bloomington, IN

6. "Semantics for Explanation" (**) Oct 24, 2025
    University of Toronto Grad Conference, Toronto, Canada

5. "Is Acquaintance a *Sui Generis* Epistemic Relation?" (*) Oct 16, 2025
    CREPH: Mind Conference, Liège, Belgium

4. "Do AI Agents Meet the Epistemic Norms for Explanation?" (*) Oct 9, 2025
    International Ontology Congress, Donostia, Basque Country

3. "The Special Questions Dispute" (**) Sep 5, 2025
    SOPhiA, Salzburg, Austria

2. "The Special Questions Dispute" (**) July 13, 2025
    Joint Session of the Aristotelian and Mind Societies, Glasgow, Scotland

1. "Composition and Metalinguistic Negotiation" (†) May 9, 2025
    Salvador Mascarenhas Lab Meeting, Institut Jean Nicod, Paris, France

Comments (†)

- Rachel Cripps: "The "Alignment" Problem" Feb 24-27, 2027
  American Philosophical Association, Central Division Meeting, Denver, CO
- Jiusi Guo: "Knowledge, Inquiry, and Taking Epistemic Logic Seriously" Oct 16, 2026
  Illinois Philosophical Association Annual Meeting, Normal, IL
- Jon Joey Telebrico: "Epistemic Debt and Responsibility" Apr 25, 2026
  Inaugural Humanities of AI Workshop, JHU, Baltimore, MD
- Adekunle Taofeek: "The Individuation Problem for Plant Souls in Panpsychist Ontology" Nov 22, 2025
  Southwest Philosophical Society Annual Meeting, Savannah, GA
- Patrick Skeels: "There can be no Dispute" Nov 8, 2025
  Illinois Philosophical Association Annual Meeting, Charleston, IL

Fellowships & Awards (Selected)

9. **Research Fellowship**, Johns Hopkins University ($12,000) 2025–2026
    Fellowship stipend to conduct research as a Visiting Scholar

8. **Tuition Subsidy**, Johns Hopkins University ($66,670) 2025–2026
    Full subsidy to take any course(s) as a visiting graduate student

7. **Honorarium**, Institut Français de la Mode (€1,600) Nov 2025
    Award for paper presentation at the Fashion and Language Symposium

6. **Graduate Paper Prize** ($100) Oct 2025
   Indiana Philosophical Association Annual Meeting, best paper by a grad student

5. **Bursary**, CREPH ARC research project: MIND (€500) Aug 2025
   Funding for presentation at the University of Liège

4. **Travel Grant**, Sorbonne Philosophy Department (€500) May 2025
   Funding for 2025 Joint Session presentation in Glasgow

3. **Paul W. Wurzburger Prize in French** ($1,000) May 2023
   Concours de la Maison Française de Cleveland, affiliated with the Alliance Française

2. **Prix Lahaurine-Johnston** ($1,000) May 2022
   Annual prize for investment in Oberlin's Maison Française

1. **John F. Oberlin Merit Scholarship** ($30,000 total) 2020–2023
   Merit scholarship, renewed for all three years I was at Oberlin

Teaching

Oberlin College 2021–2023

- Sole Grader and Tutor, Deductive Logic
- Tutor: Philosophy, French, Math, CS, Latin, Econ
- Sole Resident Assistant, Maison Française (2022–2023)
- TA (weekly session as sole instructor), Intermediate French (Spring 2021)

US Military / Rochester Institute of Technology Summer 2021

- Sole instructor: Robotics, CS, and Biochem courses for the Army Educational Outreach Program

Empirical Research

Michigan State University, Arnosti Lab Summer 2019

- Investigated modified retinoblastoma (Rbf) gene in Drosophila using dCas9 chimeras

Florida State University, Arbeitman Lab Summer 2018

- Tasked with CRISPR & U6-gRNA cloning, Drosophila cortex dissection, and gel electrophoresis

National High Magnetic Field Laboratory, Condensed Matter Lab 2015–2017
(under the supervision of Johan van Tol)

- Designed a millimeter wave resonator. When measuring polymers (e.g., polysterene), intensity increased by a factor of 8 and pulselengths decreased by a factor of 3-4 (compared to measurements without the resonator).
- Designed and built miniature solar-powered vehicle using CAD and soldering

Service & Affiliations

Referee: NeurIPS (Neural Information Processing Systems), 2026 Workshop on Interpreting Agent Behavior

Member: American Philosophical Association (Eastern), American Society for Aesthetics, Aristotelian Society, European Society for Aesthetics, European Society for Analytic Philosophy, Philosophy of Time Society, Society for Philosophy of Causation, Southwestern Philosophical Society

Board Member: Youth Advisory Board, National High Magnetic Field Laboratory (2021–2023)

Editor: *The Synapse: Intercollegiate science magazine* (2021–2022)

Graduate Coursework

- **École Normale Supérieure**[2]
  - Cognitive Models and Artificial Intelligence (Fall 2026, Heike Stein)
  - Evolutionary Foundations of Social and Cultural Behaviors (Fall 2026, Nicolas Baumard & Jean-Baptiste André)
  - Neurons, Networks, and Behavior (Fall 2026, Karim Benchenane)
  - Perception, Memory, and Core Knowledge (Fall 2026, Claudia Lunghi, Pascal Mamassian & Marine Lunven)
  - Producing and Using Data in Cognitive Science (Fall 2026, Daniel Nettle)
  - Semantics (Spring 2025, Salvador Mascarenhas)
  - Language (Fall 2024, Salvador Mascarenhas)
  - Representational Foundations of Mind (Fall 2024, Denis Buehler)
- **Johns Hopkins University** (Audited)
  - Advanced Topics in Philosophy of Mind and Cognitive Science (Spring 2026, EJ Green & Mason Westfall)
  - Puzzles about Belief (Fall 2025, Jeremy Goodman)
  - Truth-makers and Mental Models (Fall 2025, Justin Bledin)
- **Sorbonne Université**[3]
  - Philosophy of Techniques and Technology (Spring 2025, Anouk Barberousse)
  - Philosophy of Mathematics (Spring 2025, Olivier Rey)
  - Philosophy of Science in English IV (Spring 2025, Cécilia Bognon-Küss)
  - Metaphysics of Science (Fall 2024, Max Kistler)
  - Philosophy of Economics (Fall 2024, Cédric Paternotte)
  - Philosophy of Science in English III (Fall 2024, Anouk Barberousse)
  - Epistemology and Metaphysics (Spring 2024, Jean-Baptiste Rauzy)
  - Philosophy of Mind/Cognitive Science (Spring 2024, Pascal Ludwig)
  - The Implicit (Élise Marrou)
  - Advanced Logic (Spring 2024, Pascal Ludwig)
  - Philosophy of Science in English II (Spring 2024, Cédric Paternotte)
  - Authenticity (Existentialism) (Spring 2024, Claude Romano)
  - Scientific Reasoning (Fall 2023, Isabelle Drouet)
  - Philosophy of Biology (Fall 2023, Cédric Paternotte)
  - Philosophy of Physics (Fall 2023, Vincent Ardourel)
  - Intro to Logic (Fall 2023, Isabelle Drouet)
  - Philosophy of Science in English I (Fall 2023, Rayan Geha)
  - Husserlian Phenomenology (Fall 2023, Dominique Pradelle)

References are available upon request.

[2]Listed ENS courses were taught in English.

[3]Courses at Sorbonne Université were taught in French (titles translated by me), except 'Philosophy of Science in English' I-IV.